

The Former Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont

Environmental Noise Survey and Noise Impact Assessment Report

32679/PNA1-Rev2

27 November 2025

For:
BASMA
The Former Ambulance Station
Dorset Road
Belmont
Postcode: SM2 6JH



Hann Tucker Associates

Consultants in Acoustics Noise & Vibration

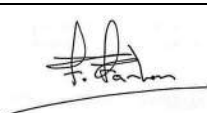
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Document Control

Rev	Date	Comment	Prepared by	Reviewed by	Approved by
2	11/12/2025	Update to reflect the multi-functional Community Hub operation hours.			
1	27/11/2025	Update to reflect the comparison in both the main body and appendix.			
0	27/11/2025	First Issue	Chirayu Kukshal Assistant Consultant B. Tech (ME), MSc	Firas Farhan Associate BSc (Hons), MIOA	



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1.0 Introduction

It is proposed to renovate and extend 'The former Ambulance Station' located at Dorset Road, Belmont. The proposed project involves the construction of a multi-functional community hub with prayer facilities, which will serve as a mosque.

Hann Tucker Associates Limited (Hann Tucker) has been commissioned by UWA Architects and BASMA to undertake a noise assessment.

Our assessment considers noise generated by the proposed multi-functional community hub with regard to the nearest noise sensitive receptors i.e. residential dwellings.

A detailed environmental noise survey at the site to establish baseline noise conditions as presented herein.

This report presents the methodology and findings of our noise survey, as well as indicative assessment of potential noise impacts.

Suitable plant noise emission criteria based on the requirements of the of the Local Authority and/or the application of BS 4142: 2014+ A1:2019 have been established, and a limiting plant noise impact assessment has been initiated and analysed.

2.0 Objectives

To establish by means of an attended and unattended noise survey the existing L_{Amax} , L_{Aeq} and L_{A90} environmental noise levels at selected secure and accessible on-site positions, using fully computerised noise monitoring equipment.

The survey will enable noise emission limits from the development to be identified with reference to the requirements of the Local Authority and to minimise the possibility of noise nuisance to neighbours.

To undertake attended noise measurements within a representative similar sized mosque hall to measure typical L_{eq} and L_{max} noise levels.

Based on our findings, to advise on the limiting noise levels within the mosque spaces to comply with planning conditions, and comment upon the suitability with regards entertainment events. Advice would be included for further mitigation measure to maximum permissible noise levels should be required.



3.0 Assessment Overview

The following section presents the findings of our indicative assessment of noise.

- Section 8.5: Environmental noise survey
- Section 10.0: Operational Activities Noise Impact Assessment
- Section 11.0: Plant Noise Emission Criteria

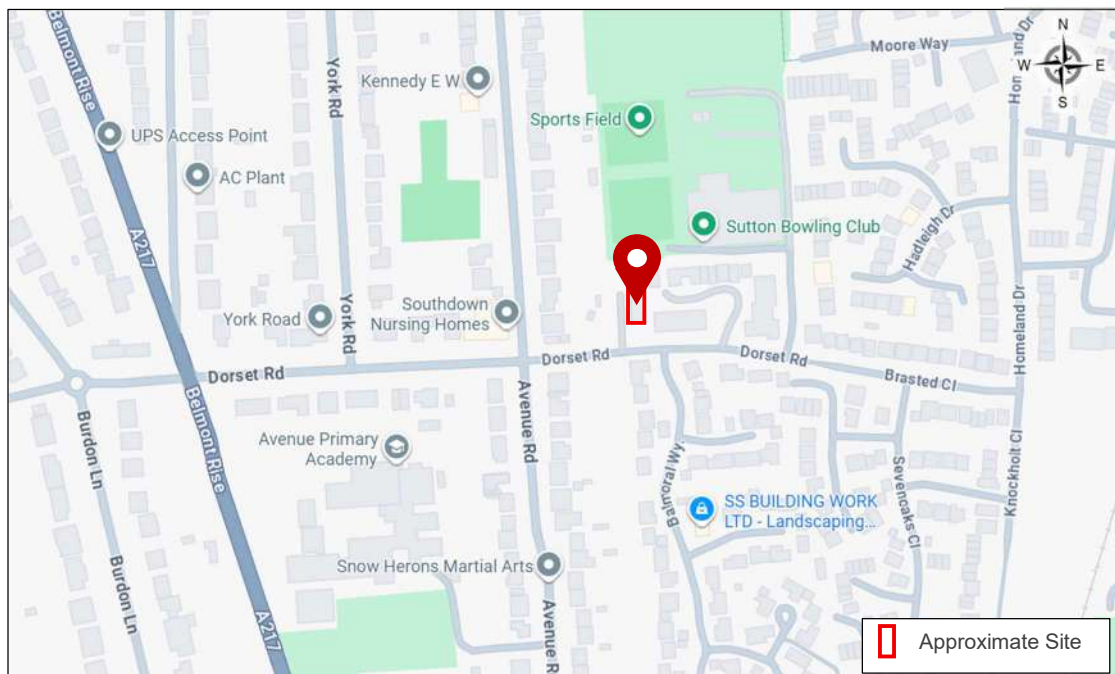
4.0 Acoustic Terminology

For an explanation of the acoustic terminology used in this report please refer to Appendix A enclosed.

5.0 Site Description

5.1 Location

The site is located at Dorset Road, Belmont, SM2 7JH. The location is shown in the Location Map below.



Location map (Imagery © 2025, Google, Imagery ©2025 Airbus, Maxar Technologies, Map data © 2025)

The site falls within the jurisdiction of London Borough of Sutton.



5.2 Description

The west side is Southdown, Nursing Home which is approximately 110 m away from the site. The site is bounded to the south by Dorset Road, to the west Avenue Road, to the east by Bowling way. The site is surrounded by residential houses, and the nearest residential premises are 8 meters away from the east boundary of the site.



Site Plan (Imagery © CNES / Airbus, Getmapping plc, Infoterra Ltd & Bluesky, Map data © 2025)

The site is shown in the Site Plan below.

6.0 Development Proposals

6.1 Proposed Development

The proposed development comprises the construction of a community hub centre which will serve as a mosque, and this site has been use as an ambulance station. The proposed multi-functional community hub comprised the construction of a level, which surrounds residential dwellings.

The key site activity in terms of noise emissions is likely to be noise breakout from operational activities from within the mosque hall.



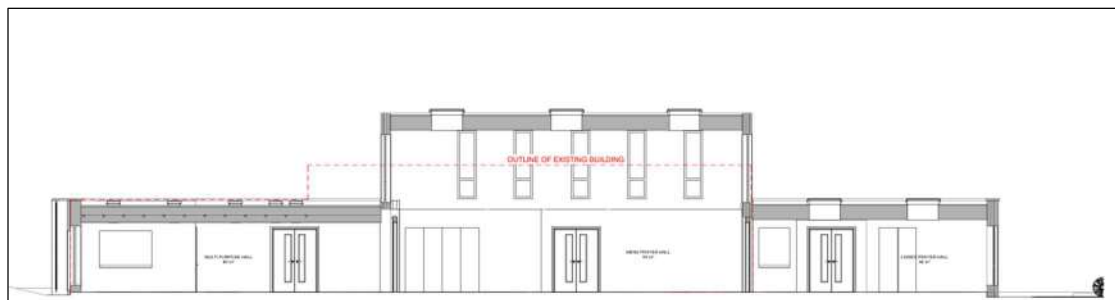
6.2 Proposed Use – Place of worship and Community Centre

The proposed development introduces a **low-impact, publicly accessible community asset**, operating under a structured weekly programme. It delivers both **religious** and **secular social infrastructure** for a wide cross-section of local residents.

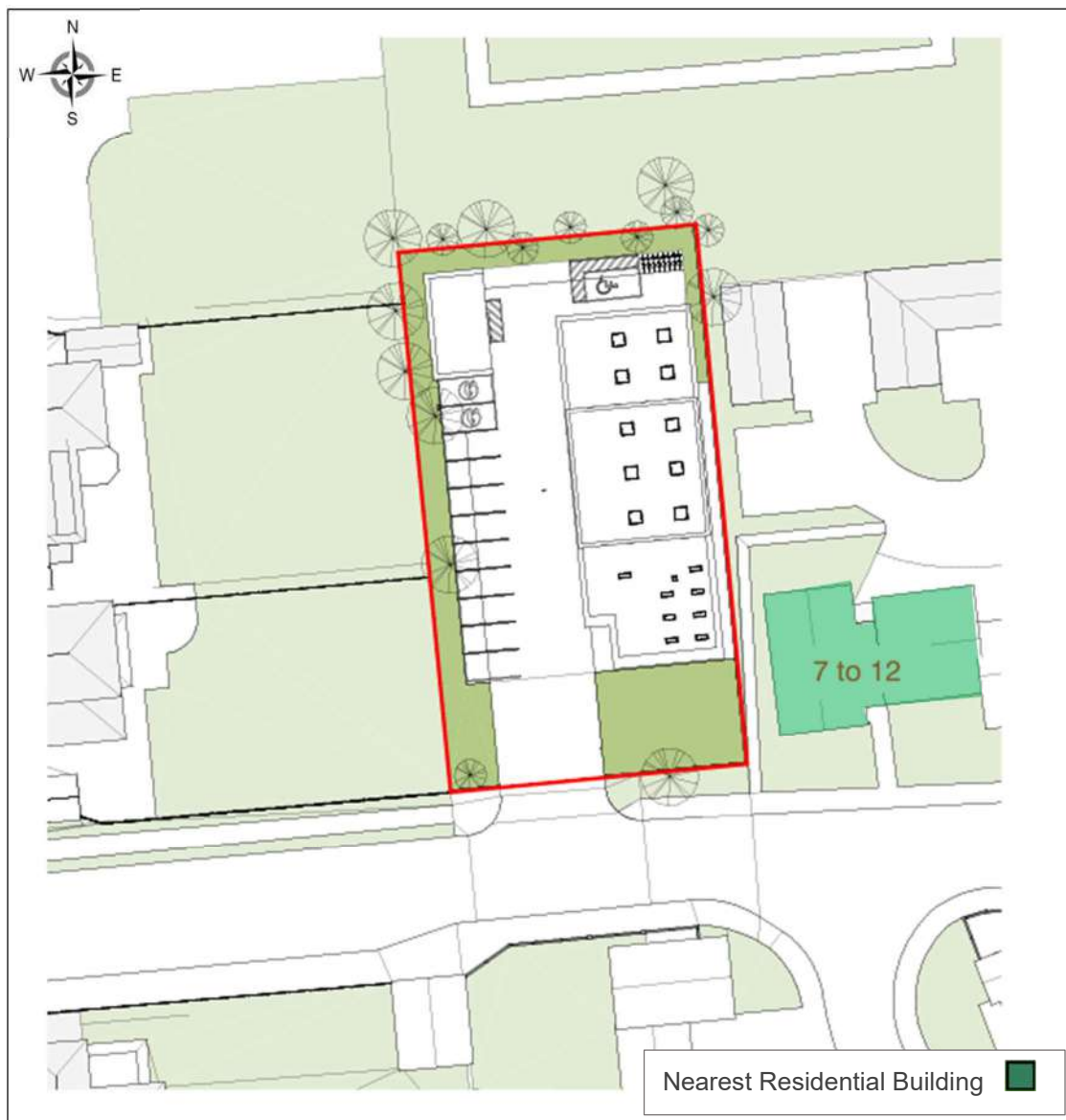
Operational Profile:

- Five daily prayer sessions (small, regular gatherings)
- One weekly Friday congregational prayer (peak use)
- Structured weekday use: Interfaith workshops, wellbeing talk.

6.3 Drawings



Section (Plan provided by UWA Architects)



Plan site (Plan provided including nearest noise sensitive receptor by UWA Architects)



7.0 Planning Policies, Standards & Guidance

7.1 Policies & Guides

In order to provide a suitable assessment a number of national planning policies have been considered.

- The National Planning Policy Framework (NPPF), 2023
- The Noise Policy Statement for England (NPSE), 2010
- Planning Practice Guidance – Noise (PPGN), 2019
- ProPG: Planning and Noise

All guidance used to form a noise impact assessment is taken from various standards, guidance, and Local Authority requirements as summarised below:

- Local Planning Policy (Sutton 2016-31)
- British Standard 4142:2014 + A1:2019
- Statutory Noise Nuisance
- World Health Organisation, 2018

Detailed information for relevant planning policies and guidance can be found within Appendix B.

7.2 Specific Local Authority Criteria

London Borough of Sutton' Local plan (2016) includes policy for noise from fixed plant, "the technical guidance for noise"

"The noise assessment should be based on BS 4142:2014+A1:2019 and ideally should demonstrate that the plant is designed to achieve a rating level of 10 dB (L_{Aeq}) below the typical/existing background (LA_{90}) level at the nearest noise sensitive location. The use of NR curves may also assist to demonstrate that the proposed plant will be acceptable in terms of frequency characteristics. Where available, product specification data for new items should be submitted with the acoustic report. Consultants should be using these to compare with data from the noise survey and propose mitigation where the levels are above objective levels. Where this information is not available, a consultant may choose to measure the noise levels generated by comparable equipment already installed elsewhere (and in accordance with the guidance in BS 4142).



Where fixed plant, equipment or machinery is attached to a building the vibration caused by it can pass through the building structure and cause structure borne noise elsewhere in the building. Where it is to be installed in or on a building containing a noise sensitive use, structure borne noise should be considered in the noise assessment and adequate control measures should be proposed."

Details shall demonstrate that the combined external noise level at maximum capacity, emitted by plant, machinery or equipment, will be at least 10dBA lower than the typically lowest existing representative background noise level LA90 (1 hour daytime (7am-7pm), 15mins evening (7pm-11pm) and night (11pm-7am). For tonal noise, a +5dB feature corrections should be added as set out in Paragraph 9.2 of BS 4142:2014. It should be recognised that the planning system is a proactive means of controlling the increase in ambient background noise within the Borough and these requirements will assist in these aim within the NPSE to "where possible contribute to the improvement of health and quality of life" and to the NPPF aim to "identify and protect areas of tranquillity which have remained relatively undisturbed by noise and are prized for their recreational and amenity value for this reason". Where noise sources exceed the Council's noise limit, details of mitigation measures will be required, such as the installation of silencers, screening, enclosures, anti-vibration isolators, relocation of the offending noise source or replacement with quieter alternatives."

8.0 Baseline Noise Survey

8.1 Procedure

Fully automated environmental noise monitoring was undertaken by Chirayu Kukshal, MSc from approximately 11:00 hours on Friday, 31st of October 2025 to 11:30 hours on Monday, 3rd of November 2025 to establish existing baseline noise levels. Measurements were taken continuously of the A-weighted (dBA) L_{90} , L_{eq} , and L_{max} sound pressure levels over discrete 15-minute periods.

Additional attended measurements were performed between 12:30 hours and 13:30 on Friday, 31st of October 2025 with the purpose of establish specific noise levels associated with specific activities within mosque during the peak praying hours. Measurements were taken continuously of the A-weighted (dBA) L_{90} , L_{eq} , and L_{max} sound pressure levels over discrete 15-minute periods.



8.2 Weather Conditions

For the unattended survey between Friday, 31st of October 2025 to Monday, 3rd of November 2025 local weather reports indicated no notable periods of prolonged rainfall, with temperatures ranging from 8 °C (night) to 12 °C (day) and wind speeds less than 5 m/s.

During our installation and collection our time on site, skies were overcast with patchy cloud cover, wind conditions were moderate, coming from the west-south direction and road condition was wet.

During the attended survey 31st of October 2025, the weather was generally wet with periods of rainfall and moderate winds.

8.3 Measurement Positions

8.3.1 Unattended Survey

The microphone was positioned on the east boundary of the property, near to noise sensitive receptor, at a height of approximately 1.5 metres above first floor level. The microphone was considered to be in 'free-field' conditions. Nearest noise sensitive receptor is located 8m from the measurement position.





8.4 Instrumentation

The instrumentation used during the survey is presented in the table below:

Position	Description	Manufacturer	Type	Serial Number	Calibration
Unattended	Type 1 Data Logging Sound Level Meter	Svantek	971	80232	Calibration on 12/07/2024
	Type 1 ½" Condenser Microphone	ACO Pacific	7052E	67976	Calibration on 12/07/2024
	Preamp	Svantek	SV18	71473	Calibration on 12/07/2024
	Type 1 Calibrator	Bruel & Kjaer	4230	494325	Calibration on 12/08/2025

For the unattended survey, the Sound Level meter, including the extension cable, was calibrated prior to and on completion of the surveys. No significant changes were found to have occurred (no more than 0.3 dB).

The sound level meter was located in an environmental case with the microphone connected to the sound level meter via an extension cable. The microphone was fitted with a windshield.

8.4.1 Attended Survey

For the attended survey, the Sound Level Metre was calibrated prior to and on the completion of the survey. The Sound Level Metre was mounted on tripod and with the microphone was fitted with a windshield.

Position	Description	Manufacturer	Type	Serial Number	Calibration
Attended	Preamp	Svantek	SV12L	42465	Calibration on 04/02/2025
	Type 1 ½" Condenser Microphone	ACO Pacific	7052E	59147	Calibration on 04/02/2025
	Type 1 Data Logging Sound Level Meter	Svantek	977	36448	Calibration on 04/02/2025
	Type 1 Calibrator	Bruel & Kjaer	4230	494325	Calibration on 12/08/2025

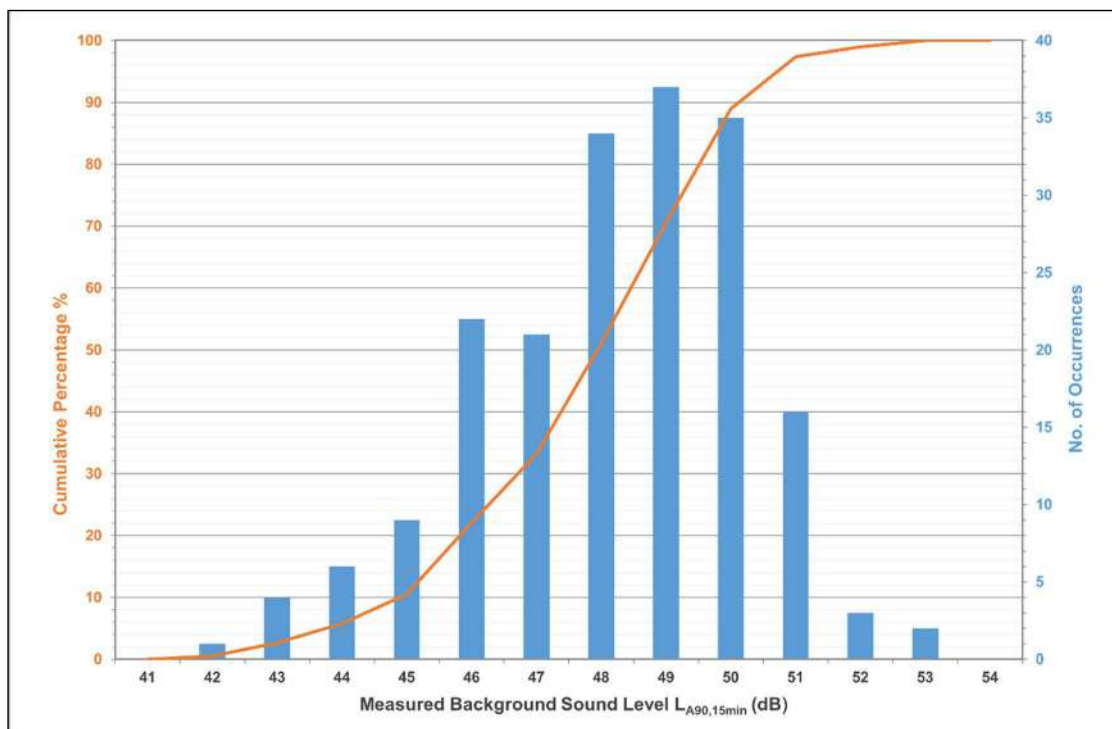


8.5 Results

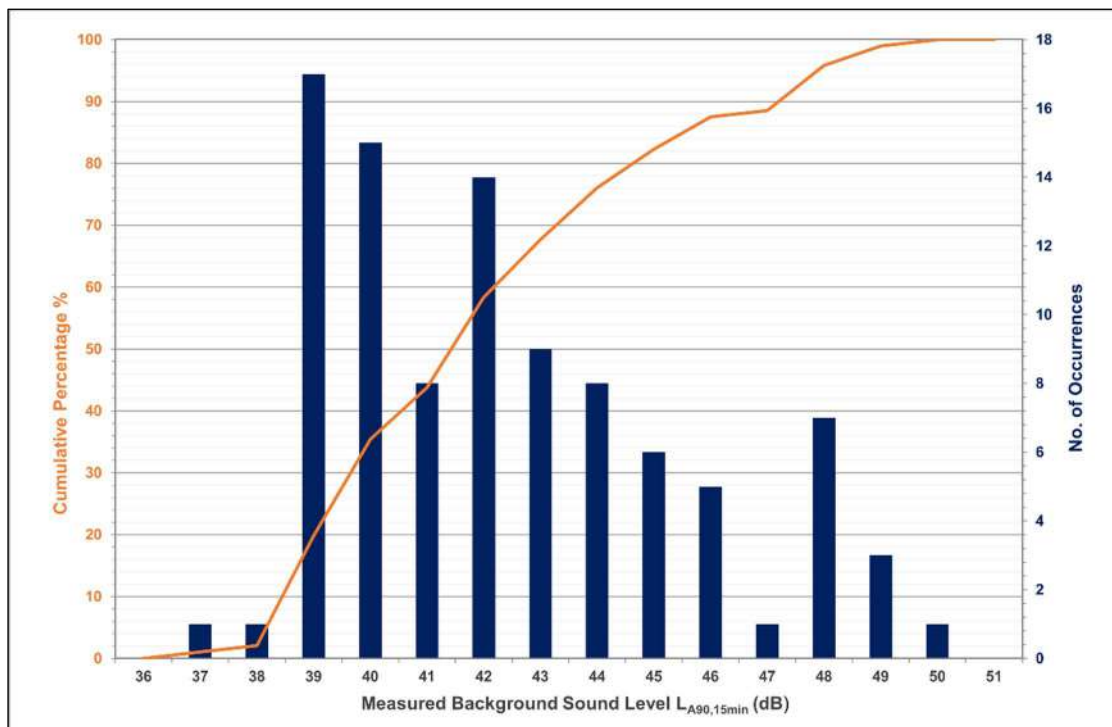
8.5.1 Unattended Survey

The results have been plotted on Time History Graph 32629/TH1 enclosed in Appendix C presenting the 15-minute A-weighted (dBA) L_{90} , L_{eq} and L_{max} levels at each measurement position throughout the duration of the survey.

BS 4142 states that “the background sound level must be reliable and suitably represent the particular circumstances and periods of interest. For this purpose, the objective is not simply to ascertain a lowest measured background sound level, but rather to quantify what is typical during particular time periods.” Taking this into account, the following histograms have been created which display the occurrence of each sound level (L_{A90}) for the day and night-time periods”. Taking this into account, the following histograms have been created which displays the occurrence of each sound level (L_{90}) as a percentage for the day and night-time periods.



Statistical analysis of daytime (Mosque operational hours) background noise levels (7:00-23:00 hrs)



Statistical analysis of night-time background noise levels (23:00-7:00 hrs)

A summary of the results from the environmental noise survey, as used to inform subsequent assessment of environmental noise impact, are presented in the table below.

Position	Representative Measured $L_{A90(15min)}$ Background Sound Level – Operational Hours (7:00-23:00) (dB re 2×10^{-5} Pa)
1	46

Date	Daytime (07:00 – 23:00) Hours		Night-Time (23:00 – 07:00) Hours	
	$L_{Aeq,16h}$	Typical $L_{A90,15 min}$	$L_{Aeq,8h}$	Typical $L_{A90,15 min}$
Friday, 31/10/2025	56*	46	51	39
Saturday, 1/11/2025	55		46	
Sunday, 2/11/2025	53		47	
Monday, 3/11/2025	56*		-	

*Denotes insufficient data for specific time period. Note: Units are in dBA

The above levels are measured at the measurement position and does not include facade reflection.

8.5.2 Attended Survey and Source noise data

Based on recent measurement undertaken, typical worst-case internal reverberant noise levels



are presented on the table below.

Description	Measured Internal Mosque Hall Noise Levels Sound Pressure Level (dB) at Octave Band Centre Frequency (Hz)							dBA
	63	125	250	500	1k	2k	4k	
L _{Aeq}	45	46	47	44	40	38	36	46
L _{Fmax}	77	89	88	88	78	73	64	87

The above levels include amplified speech by Imam includes rhythmic sounds during the peak praying hours.

9.0 Noise Criteria

Based on the above, we propose the criteria should not exceed the typical measured background level during operating hours.

We understand the operating hours of the proposed development will be restricted to daytime hours (07:00-23:00). Based on our noise survey results, the typical measured L_{A90, 15minutes} over this period was 46 dBA. The octave band and dBA values are also outlined in the table below.

Description	Mosque Service Noise Level Limit (dB L _{90, 15 min}) at Octave Band Centre Frequency (Hz)								dBA
	63	125	250	500	1k	2k	4k	8k	
Residential dwellings east façade	45	45	42	40	44	38	28	26	46

10.0 Operational Activities Noise Impact Assessment

We understand the operating hours of the proposed development will be restricted to daytime hours (07:00-23:00).

Our assessment has been on noise level data undertaken within a similar sized mosque hall (St. John Church) which is being used by the BASMA Mosque community, to provide an indication of the significance of potential noise impacts on nearby residential dwellings against the noise criteria outlined in section 9.0. The noise levels measured are considered to be a typical worst-case scenario of an amplified speech.

For this development, the nearest residential noise sensitive receptor is approximately 8 metres



away from the east façade of the mosque.

10.1 Assessment Assumptions

We have established operational internal noise limiting levels from mosque noise based on the following assumptions:

- Noise will be dominated by general reverberant noise within each space, rather than specific activities.
- Our assessment will consider that all the doors and windows of the mosque would be closed.
- Typical and standard double glazing for windows 6/16/6 sealed standard (BS 6262) and 336 mm plastered for wall construction.

10.2 Noise Breakout between Mosque to Nearest Noise sensitive Receptors

We have assessed noise breakout to the nearest receptors based on standard calculation procedures for reverberant noise breakout and source noise levels in Section 9.0. The resultant external noise level has been calculated using the following equation.

$$SPL_{out} = SPL_{in} - SRI + 10 \log_{10} \left(\frac{S}{r^2} \right) - 14$$

Where:

SRI estimated sound reduction performance of façade element

r distance from radiating element to receptors

S approximate area of radiating element

The SRI has been calculated based on the drawings provided by the client, which include details of the mosque's walls. Nearest residential noise sensitive receptor is located 8m from the proposed development.

Our indicative assessment based on typical maximum mosque noise levels L_{max} is detailed below. The daytime criterion has been used due to operational hours

Description	Octave Band Centre Frequency (Hz)							dBA
	63	125	250	500	1k	2k	4k	
Typical maximum Mosque service noise levels L_{max}	77	89	88	88	78	73	64	87
Estimated composite SRI of Mosque's East facade	-27	-32	-33	-38	-41	-37	-43	



Distance & radiating area propagation correction (dB) $+10\log_{10}\left(\frac{S}{r^2}\right)$	+3	+3	+3	+3	+3	+3	+3	
Internal diffuse field to external free-field hemispherical radiation correction (dB) -14	-14	-14	-14	-14	-14	-14	-14	
External noise level at nearest residential receptor (dB $L_{\text{fmax}, 1\text{min}}$) SPL_{out}	39	46	44	39	26	25	10	40
Background noise at nearest receptor ($LA_{90, 15\text{ min}}$) (7:00-23:00 hours)	45	45	42	40	44	38	28	46

Our calculation indicates that the external noise level at the nearest sensitive receptors is likely to be below 6 dB from the background noise level. Based on the above table, it is highly unlikely to exceed the Local Authority's criteria.

11.0 Plant Noise Emission Criteria

Building services plant external noise emission levels will need to comply with local authority requirements as outlined in Section 8.5.

On the basis of the above and the results of the environmental noise survey, we propose that the following plant noise emission criteria be achieved at 1 metre from the nearest noise sensitive residential window.

Location	Plant Noise Emission Criteria (dB)	
	Daytime (07:00 – 23:00) Hours	Night-Time (23:00 – 07:00) Hours
Lowest measured L_{90} noise level	41	37
Local Authority Requirements	-10	
Plant noise Emission Limit at the nearest noise sensitive receptor	31	27

The above criteria are to be achieved with all plant operating simultaneously. It should be noted that the above are subject to the final approval of the Local Authority.



12.0 Conclusions

An environmental noise survey has been undertaken in order to establish the currently prevailing noise levels.

The acoustic requirements of national/local policies, current industry guidelines and other relevant documentation have been reviewed and used to inform an assessment of potential noise impacts associated with the proposed development.

Indicative noise egress assessments have been carried out to demonstrate that acceptable noise levels at existing noise sensitive receptors can be practically achieved. Our calculations indicate that external noise levels at the nearest noise sensitive receptors would not exceed the background noise level using the typical/representative noise levels at the site.

Plant noise emission criteria have been recommended based on the results of the noise survey and with reference to the Local Authority's requirements. Furthermore, a comparative review of the proposal use as a multi-functional community hub with prayer facilities against the former ambulance station indicates that the anticipated noise impact will be lower than the historic operational profile of the site, as detailed in Appendix B.

Appendix A

The acoustic terms used in this report are defined as follows:

dB Decibel - Used as a measurement of sound level. Decibels are not an absolute unit of measurement but an expression of ratio between two quantities expressed in logarithmic form. The relationships between Decibel levels do not work in the same way that non-logarithmic (linear) numbers work (e.g. 30dB + 30dB = 33dB, not 60dB).

dBA The human ear is more susceptible to mid-frequency noise than the high and low frequencies. The 'A'-weighting scale approximates this response and allows sound levels to be expressed as an overall single figure value in dBA. The _A subscript is applied to an acoustical parameter to indicate the stated noise level is A-weighted

It should be noted that levels in dBA do not have a linear relationship to each other; for similar noises, a change in noise level of 10dBA represents a doubling or halving of subjective loudness. A change of 3dBA is just perceptible.

L_{90,T} L₉₀ is the noise level exceeded for 90% of the period *T* (i.e. the quietest 10% of the measurement) and is often used to describe the background noise level.

L_{eq,T} L_{eq,T} is the equivalent continuous sound pressure level. It is an average of the total sound energy measured over a specified time period, *T*.

L_{max} L_{max} is the maximum sound pressure level recorded over the period stated. L_{max} is sometimes used in assessing environmental noise where occasional loud noises occur, which may have little effect on the L_{eq} noise level.

Sound Pressure Level (L_p) is the sound pressure relative to a standard reference pressure of 2×10^{-5} Pa. This level varies for a given source according to a number of factors (including but not limited to: distance from the source; positioning; screening and meteorological effects).

Sound Power Level (SWL or L_w) is the total amount of sound energy inherent in a particular sound source, independent of its environment. It is a logarithmic measure of the sound power in comparison to a specified reference level (usually 10^{-12} W).

Appendix B

Planning Policies, Standards & Guidance

B.1 BS 4142:2014 + A1:2019

When setting plant noise emission criteria reference is commonly made to BS 4142:2014 *“Methods for rating and assessing industrial and commercial sound”*.

The procedure contained in BS 4142:2014 provides an assessment of the likely effects of sound on people when comparing the specific noise levels from the source with representative background noise levels. Where the noise contains “a tone, impulse or other characteristic” then various corrections can be added to the specific (source) noise level to obtain the “rating level”.

BS 4142 states that: *“The significance of sound of an industrial and/or commercial nature depends upon both the margin by which the rating level of the specific sound source exceeds the background sound level and the context in which the sound occurs”. An estimation of the impact of the specific noise can be obtained by the difference of the rating noise level and the background noise level and considering the following:*

- *“Typically, the greater this difference, the greater the magnitude of the impact.”*
- *“A difference of around +10dB or more is likely to be an indication of a significant adverse impact, depending on the context.”*
- *“A difference of around +5dB is likely to be an indication of an adverse impact, depending on the context.”*
- *“The lower the rating level is relative to the measured background sound level, the less likely it is that the specific sound source will have an adverse impact or a significant adverse impact. Where the rating level does not exceed the background sound level, this is an indication of the specific sound source having a low impact, depending on the context.”*

The determination of the “rating level” and the “background level” are both open to interpretation, depending on the context.

B.2 Statutory Noise Nuisance

S79(1)(g) of the Environmental Protection Act 1990 defines a statutory nuisance as “*noise emitted from a premises so as to be prejudicial to health or a nuisance*”. A duty is placed on the Local Authority to serve an abatement notice under S80 if it becomes satisfied that a statutory nuisance exists.

There is however no quantitative definition/objective method in determining statutory noise nuisance, and as such we are not able to definitively advise or determine on such matters. Noise nuisance is subjective and requires multiple factors to be considered, including but not limited to:

- Straining to hear something is *generally* considered not a nuisance, however,
- Noise level (of source and relative to background), timing, duration, type of noise, frequency, location, continuous or repetitive, all factor into judging nuisance.

To mitigate against, though not remove entirely, the risk of a statutory noise nuisance, a noise assessment should be undertaken by a Suitably Qualified Acoustician. Adoption of appropriate and relevant industry standards/guides can provide a structured framework for such assessments, improving the credibility of mitigation efforts. It is also important to also recognise that ongoing management (both active and passive) may also be necessary depending on the context of the situation.

B.3 World Health Organisation Guidelines on Community Noise

BS8233:2014 is based upon the current World Health Organisation (WHO) guidance “*Guidelines on Community Noise*”. A summary of the noise guidelines relevant to the proposed scheme is presented in the table below.

Residential Environment	Critical Health Effect(s)	L _{Aeq}	L _{AFmax}	Time Base
Outdoor living area	Serious annoyance, daytime and evening	55	-	07:00-23:00
	Moderate annoyance, daytime and evening	50	-	07:00-23:00
Dwelling, indoors	Speech intelligibility and moderate annoyance, daytime and evening	35	-	07:00-23:00
Inside bedrooms	Sleep disturbance, night-time	30	45	23:00-07:00
Outside bedrooms	Sleep disturbance, window open (outdoor values)	45	60	23:00-07:00

These WHO guidelines are based, in almost all cases, on the lower threshold below which the occurrence rates of any particular effect can be assumed to be negligible.

B.4 Former Use – Ambulance station and purposed Place of worship

The Dorset Road site was historically used as a local ambulance depot, operated by the **London Ambulance Service NHS Trust**. Its decommissioning in 2024 formed part of a wider LAS estate rationalisation and shift toward regional deployment hubs.

Operational Profile:

- 24-hour operating potential
- Frequent, unpredictable **blue-light vehicle movements**
- On-site staff presence across multiple shifts
- Clinical waste handling and medical logistics
- Potential for **noise and visual impact** at sensitive times (early/late hours)

Social Infrastructure Role: While the site functioned primarily as a logistical hub, the LAS also played a **community-facing educational role**, through:

- **Health education workshops** in schools, colleges, and youth groups
- Public guidance on first aid, mental health, and responsible use of 999/111 services
- Engagement with at-risk groups (sensory loss, autism, older people)

As such, the site previously contributed — indirectly — to the community's wellbeing and resilience, albeit in a decentralised and non-regular manner.

Category	Former LAS Use	Purposed BASMA Use
Public Purpose	NHS emergency response and public education	Religious, cultural, educational, and wellbeing support
Access Model	Operational base only; no public access	Fully community-accessible facility
Hours of Use	24/7 operational potential	Controlled daily access; limited to daytime and early evening
Traffic Profile	Unpredictable; emergency response vehicles	Scheduled and low-impact; mostly pedestrian-based and local
Noise Profile	Sirens, vehicle activity, shift handovers	No amplified sound: quiet-use policies enforced
Educational Role	Outreach-based; mainly off-site	On-site educational support for children, youth, and health-awareness events
Amenity Impact	High intensity uses with limited mitigation	Low-intensity use, carefully managed through programming and design
Community Identity	Operated as a healthcare outpost	Localised and embedded in neighbourhood's demographic and cultural context
Use of Outdoor Areas	Vehicle yard, storage	Greened amenity, cycle storage, accessible entrances and passive seating

Appendix C

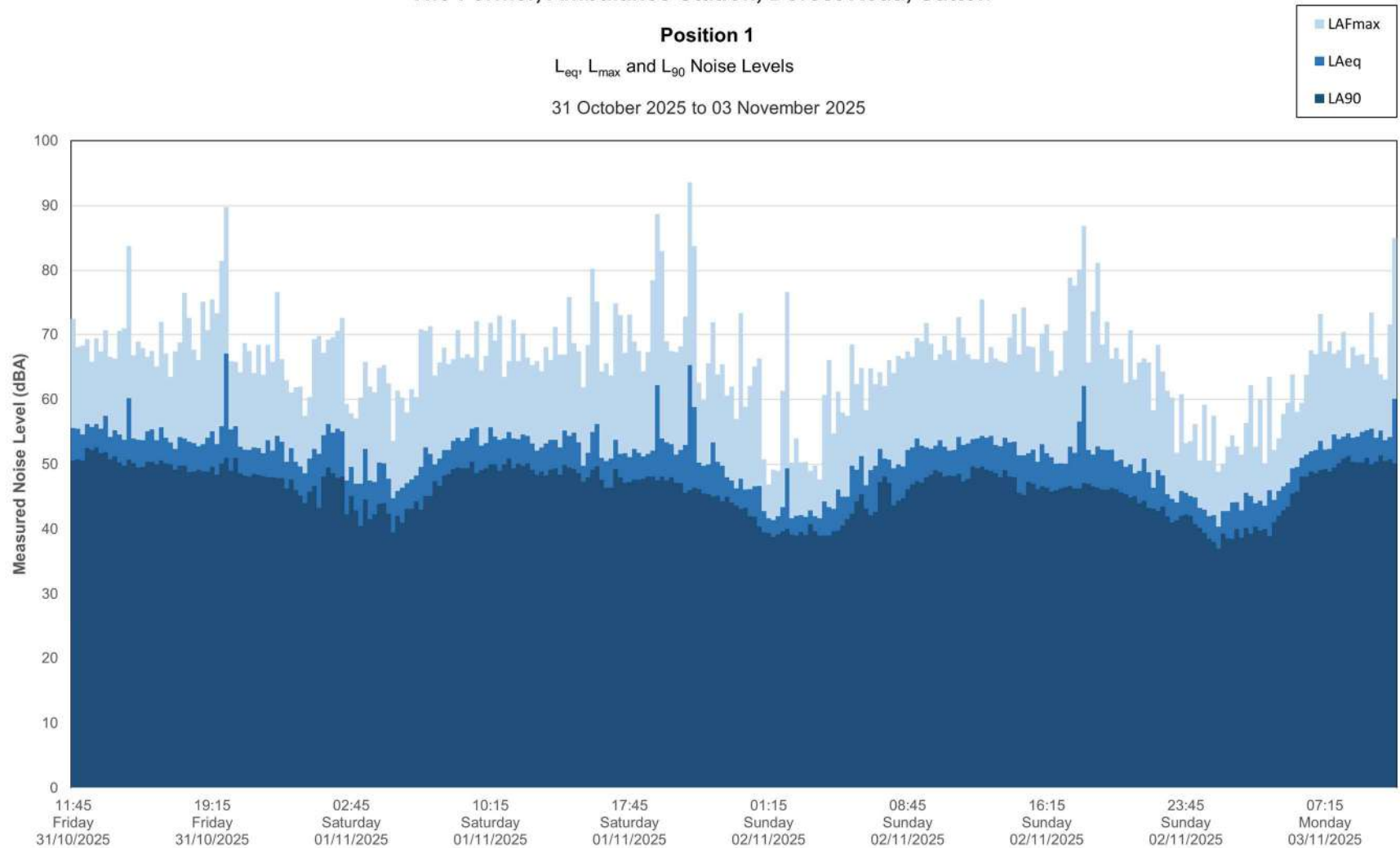
Time History Graph

The Former, Ambulance Station, Dorset Road, Sutton

Position 1

L_{eq} , L_{max} and L_{90} Noise Levels

31 October 2025 to 03 November 2025



Time and Date

32679/TH1